RE: Question on the academic entry requirements for Paramedic Science at UH

From: Aryan Thanki aryanthanki313@hotmail.com
To: cpdhealth@herts.ac.uk
Date: Tue, 5 Nov 2024, 13:10

Hello

I have a question on whether course entry requirements for the paramedic science course offered by your department at the University of Hertfordshire adequately and clearly reflect the nature of the academic course content, level of complexity of said course content, and the course examinations.

If entry requirements, are set at a particular level, requiring students to have a particular grade or particular grades in given subjects does this mean that all three elements above- the academic course content, level of complexity of said course content, and the course examinations, are designed to be accessible to the student cohort entering said course with the grades you stipulated (which is why the requirements are what they are).

For instance, Radiography asks for a grade B in Biology A Level. Does that mean the course is completable and accessible to students who have a grade B in Biology (implicating you do not need to have an A or an A* in Biology to complete the course as that is not what you ask for).

And if entry requirements differ, these differing requirements reflect the specific requirements and nature of the course they relate to, and hence are accessible to the student body specific to that course.

Many thanks and I look forward to hearing from you soon

Aryan

From: paramedic-admissions, UH paramedic-admissions@herts.ac.uk
To: aryanthanki313@hotmail.com
Date: Mon, 11 Nov 2024, 09:15

Dear Aryan,

Thank you for contacting us with your questions regarding the entry requirements for the Paramedic Science course at the University of Hertfordshire.

Our specific entry requirements, including the UCAS tariff and subject grades, are designed to ensure that students entering the programme have the foundational knowledge and readiness to succeed in the course.

The entry requirements reflect the academic rigour and subject matter students will encounter in the course. For instance, a foundational understanding in subjects like Biology or Chemistry supports students' grasp of the human body, disease processes, and pharmacology—key areas in paramedic science. These standards help ensure students can engage meaningfully with complex material from the outset. Paramedic Science is a demanding field, both academically and practically, and entry requirements are one way we identify students likely to thrive in this environment. Students entering with the specified background knowledge are better positioned to develop clinical skills, critical thinking, and decision-making abilities essential for paramedic practice.

Data from previous admissions cycles show that students who meet or exceed these entry standards are more likely to succeed academically and complete the course. The requirements help us manage the balance between accessibility and the likelihood of students progressing and achieving the programme's high standards. Entry requirements are also benchmarked against similar healthcare programmes in the UK to maintain consistent standards across the sector. While each course may vary in its specific requirements based on subject focus and professional demands, a standardised approach helps ensure students across healthcare disciplines are entering with an appropriate level of preparedness.

Finally, it's important to note that while minimum academic requirements provide a baseline, success in the degree also depends on qualities beyond prior academic achievement. The course's demands require resilience, adaptability, problem-solving, and interpersonal skills that are developed throughout the programme. A grade in a particular subject, while indicative of preparedness, does not automatically make the degree "completable"—our programme is designed to challenge and develop students in multiple dimensions.

To your point on comparability with other programmes, such as Radiography, it's true that similar principles guide each programme's entry criteria.

I hope this provides the clarification you're looking for. Please don't hesitate to contact me directly if you have further questions.
Kind regards,

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